

▶ **SADHGURU**
Founder, Isha Foundation

A HEALING TOUCH

'Seekers' from across India and the world make a beeline for his Isha Foundation centre and Sadhguru, for one, believes that having doubts is "very healthy". "Questions cannot be wrong," he says. "Only the answer can be." Speaking at the India Today Conclave, the spiritual guru touched on several issues and not just spiritual ones, but also some of the contentious social and political topics of the day.

Welcoming the recent notification of the Citizenship (Amendment) Act, 2019, for instance, he said it doesn't pertain to any religion. Calling the move "too little compassion coming too late", he said the refugees who will benefit from it have suffered for decades. "When we left people on the other side of the border post-Partition, there was hope that they will be taken care of," he said. "There was also a promise in the political space that if there are problems, we will take [you] back. But, over 75 years, they have faced the worst of the worst. Many of them moved here 30-40 years ago, but are still refugees in this country...they don't have any rights. This is not a controversy. This is a matter of shame."

Admitting that there were still a "thousand varieties of discrimination in our society", Sadhguru reminded the gathering that when it comes to the law, nobody is discriminated with in India. "But in the neighbouring lands, by law, they're discriminated," he added. "There are blasphemy laws, [under] which if you just say a [wrong] word, you could be hanged for it."

Sharing his thoughts on Ram Rajya, Sadhguru said that, metaphorically, it means "a striving for a just rule". "It doesn't mean everything was just during Ram's time... but there was a striving." Though some people out of their love for him call him Lord, generally Ram is referred to as Purushottam, he said. "Purushottam means *uttama* among the *purushas*—a man who has risen...because this is essentially a civilisation where we are not waiting for some gods to descend from somewhere. We are always seeing how to devise ways where a human being can rise to his ultimate possibility.... So, in that context, Ram Rajya means striving for a perfect nation or a just nation," he explained.

An important step towards Ram Rajya, said Sadhguru, is the 'one nation, one poll' move. "There must be a time for election. And there must be time for administration," he added, while pointing out how the cycle of constant elections was hampering governance. "Till we get to a $10-12 trillion economy," he said, "we should have election once in eight years." For, in order for any policy to bring about any change and its benefits to trickle down to the last man in a village, said Sadhguru, it takes at least six to eight years. ■

IN THE NATION RIGHT NOW, THERE IS A HUGE STRIVING FOR ECONOMIC WELL-BEING. EVERYBODY IS THINKING THEY WILL LIVE BETTER. THEY ARE ALREADY LIVING BETTER AND ARE STRIVING FOR MORE

FOR ME, THERE ARE NO TYCOONS. THERE ARE NO CRIMINALS. THERE ARE NO TYRANTS. FOR ME, THERE ARE HUMAN BEINGS, AND EVERY HUMAN BEING HAS A SPACE FOR TRANSFORMATION

IN OUR CULTURE, WE ENCOURAGE QUESTIONING, BECAUSE THIS IS A LAND OF SEEKING. THIS IS NOT A LAND OF BELIEVING. WE DON'T HAVE ANY BELIEF SYSTEM. WE SEEK. *MUKTI* IS THE GOAL

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